Let's understand better:

Another senior member of the bank, Baldwin, father of John and Evie, and husband of Martha, is however believed to be honest.

BALDWIN: What kind of things, John?

JOHN: You can imagine; rotten things. And I couldn't contradict them.

BALDWIN: Why not, John?

JOHN: Because I didn't know.

BALDWIN: Did you have to know? Wasn't it enough that you knew your father?

JOHN: [*after a pause*] I beg your pardon, Sir.

BALDWIN: It was only a day before the **smash-up** that I found out what Gresham was doing. (*He pauses. They are listening intently*.) I told him he would have to make good. He said he couldn't…

EVIE: And what happened?

BALDWIN: I told him he would have to do the best he could–and the first step would be to close the bank. He didn't want to do that.

MARTHA: But he did it.

BALDWIN: I made him do it. He was angry–very angry, but I had the whip hand.

EVIE: The papers didn't mention that.

BALDWIN: I didn't think it was necessary to tell them.

MARTHA: But you let your name rest under a cloud meanwhile.

BALDWIN: It will be cleared tomorrow, won't it? (*He pauses*) Today Gresham sent for me. The trial begins in twenty-four hours. I'm the only witness against him. He asked - you can guess what…

JOHN: (***indignantly***) He wanted you lie to save his skin, eh? Wanted you to **perjure** yourself?

BALDWIN: That wouldn't be necessary, John. He just wanted me to have an attack of poor memory. If I tell all I know, John Gresham will go to jail–no power on earth can save him from it. But he wants me to forget a little- just the essential things. When they question me I can answer, "I don't remember". They can't prove I do remember. And there you are.

JOHN: It would be a lie, Dad!

BALDWIN: (*smiling*) Of course. But it's done every day. And they couldn't touch me – any more than they could convict him.

MARTHA: (*quivering with indignation*) How dared he – how dared he ask such a thing?

EVIE: What did you say, Father?

BALDWIN: (*smiling, and raising his eyes to John's*) Well son, what would you have said?

JOHN: I'd have told him to go to the devil.

BALDWIN: I did… but I didn't use your words, John, he's too old a friend of mine for that. However, I didn't mince matters any. He understood what I meant.

EVIE: And what did he say then?

BALDIN: There wasn't much to say. You

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